

Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: translate *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ* and discuss its ecological implication.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. “cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **The text.** *Īśāvāsyā Upaniṣad* (a short Upaniṣad, 18 verses), mantra 1: > *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ yat kiñca jagatyāṁ jagat / > tena tyaktena bhuñjīthā mā gṛdhaḥ kasya svid dhanam //*

Translation: “*All this — whatever moves in this moving world — is enveloped by the Lord. Enjoy through renunciation. Do not covet anyone’s wealth.*”

2. **The ecological reading.** *Tyaktena bhuñjīthā* — “enjoy by renouncing.” Use the world, but with restraint. Take only what you need; leave the rest. This is one of the strongest non-greed ethics in any wisdom tradition.
3. **Modern parallel.** Steady-state economics (Herman Daly). Voluntary simplicity. Donut economics (Kate Raworth). The principle: don’t grow beyond ecological limits.
4. **Source.** *Īśāvāsyā Upaniṣad* is part of the Yajurveda. Translations: Eknath Easwaran, Stephen Phillips academic editions.
5. **Discussion.** “*How does ‘enjoy by renouncing’ apply to your own life? Phone usage? Food? Clothes? Travel?*” Each student writes 3 sentences. NO right answer — the point is HONEST self-reflection.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).